INCOMPLETE (narrower after the 2026-11-06 gap-fill pass). Sections (a) and (b) are sourced. Sections (c) "task change not job loss" and (d) "freedom to be more human backfires" now have sourced findings (radiology, translators, bank tellers, Autor; deskilling, intensification, algorithmic management, social penalty), all from search-engine extracts with no page fetched. Still missing: primary-source checks of BLS teller and radiologist counts and NRMP residency numbers; the Hui, Reshef and Zhou freelancer earnings paper; Autor and Thompson's 2025 "Expertise" paper; newer agent benchmark scores; Census BTOS firm AI-use rates; any verbatim quotes.

Track 10: Contrarian

Last updated: 2026-11-06. Labels: EVIDENCE = measured/primary data; FORECAST = projection; OPINION = argument, vendor or consultancy view.

Verification note (added 2026-11-06): page fetches were blocked for most hosts this session, so findings marked search summary, search extract or snippet rest on search-engine extracts of the cited URL. Quotation marks inside findings mark wording as reported by that source; only quotes in this file's "Verbatim quotes" section (and in 13-quotes.md) were checked against a fetched page. Corrections from the verification pass are in verification.md.

Access note. In this session every direct page fetch failed (curl and WebFetch both refused by the network proxy: nber.org, arxiv.org, metr.org, sequoiacap.com, budgetlab.yale.edu, ideas.repec.org, bls.gov, census.gov and others). Every finding below comes from web-search results that showed the source URL with an excerpt or summary. No page was read in full. Figures are therefore "seen in search excerpt, not re-read at source" and should be re-verified at the URL before publication. No verbatim quotes are given, because none could be checked against a fetched page.

Summary

- **The macro numbers do not yet show an AI boom.** US private nonfarm total factor productivity grew 0.8% in 2025, down from 1.5% in 2024, and labour productivity slowed from 3.0% to 2.2%, in the first full year of mass generative-AI use (BLS, 19 March 2026). UK output per hour fell 0.8% in Q2 2026. The fair counter: US labour productivity has run at about 2.1% a year since late 2019, which is respectable, and the productivity J-curve predicts measured gains lag heavy intangible investment.
- **The best micro evidence on ordinary workers shows small gains.** Self-reported time savings are about 1.4% of all US work hours (Bick, Blandin, Deming). In Denmark, chatbot adoption across about 25,000 workers in 11 exposed occupations produced precise null effects on earnings and recorded hours, with average time savings around 3% and only 3-7% of the benefit passed through to pay (Humlum and Vestergaard, NBER, May 2025).
- **The serious top-down macro forecast is modest.** Acemoglu's task-based estimate is at most 0.66% higher TFP over ten years, and below 0.53% once harder tasks are accounted for (Economic Policy, 2025). This is a model, not a measurement, and it excludes new tasks.
- **The spending-to-revenue gap is the strongest "less profitable" argument.** Hyperscaler capex for 2026 is reported at roughly $800bn; Bain (Sept 2025) says $2tn of annual revenue is needed by 2030 to fund the compute trend and projects an $800bn shortfall even after counting AI savings. Markets have had several sharp AI sell-offs in 2026 (February, late April, mid-October), but none has yet reduced planned capex: executives still guide higher for 2027.

- **Agents fail most where business work actually happens: multi-turn, policy-bound, repeated.** Salesforce's own CRMArena-Pro: about 58% success single-turn falling to about 35% multi-turn, with near-zero confidentiality awareness. On tau-bench, GPT-4o's retail success above 60% on one try fell to about 25% when it had to succeed 8 times in a row. TheAgentCompany: the best agent fully completed about 30% of simulated office tasks.
- **The headline "developers are 19% slower with AI" is real but narrow and now dated.** n=16 experienced open-source developers, early-2025 tools. METR's own 2026 redesign says its newer data cannot give a reliable estimate, partly because developers now refuse to work without AI. It has not been reversed; it has become unmeasurable by that design.
- **Gartner's "over 40% of agentic AI projects cancelled by end-2027" and "only about 130 genuine agentic vendors" are a forecast and an opinion,** but they cut against vendor hype from inside the analyst mainstream.
- **"Task change, not job loss" holds for radiology and salaried work so far, but not for freelance translation.** Practising US radiologists rose about 12% from 2010 to 2022 and pay rose, nine years after Hinton's "stop training radiologists". But on a large freelance platform, writing and coding posts fell about 21% within eight months of ChatGPT (Demirci, Hannane, Zhu, Management Science 2025), and most freelance translators reported price falls for the first time in 2025 (ELIS survey). The teller story shows task change can last two decades and then turn into job loss.
- **The "freedom to be more human" evidence is early and mixed, with real warning signs.** Endoscopists' unaided adenoma detection fell from 28.4% to 22.4% after routine AI use (Lancet Gastroenterology & Hepatology, Oct 2025; observational, 19 doctors, confounded). AI users are judged lazier and less competent (PNAS 2025, N=4,439). Workload surveys point to intensification, but the best register data show no rise in recorded hours.
- **For the thesis:** the contrarian evidence partly supports "the tech is the easy part" (adoption friction, unmeasured reorganisation) but partly contradicts it. Agent reliability on multi-turn, permission-sensitive tasks is a technology limit, not only a readiness problem. A business with perfectly documented workflows would still see a 35% multi-turn success rate on CRMArena-Pro.

Key findings

(a) Transformation slower, narrower or less profitable than claimed

Macro forecasts

- **[FORECAST]** Acemoglu estimates AI raises US TFP by no more than 0.66% over ten years, using task-exposure shares and early experimental productivity estimates aggregated via a version of Hulten's theorem. He then argues this is likely too high because early evidence comes from easy-to-learn tasks, cutting the estimate to below 0.53%. He also predicts AI widens the gap between capital and labour income. Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI", NBER w32487 (May 2024); Economic Policy 40(121): 13-58 (2025). https://www.nber.org/papers/w32487 https://econpapers.repec.org/RePEc:oup:ecpoli:v:40:y:2025:i:121:p:13-58. https://dspace.mit.edu/handle/1721.1/166327
- **[OPINION]** Counter: critics argue the model excludes new tasks, new products and complementarity channels, so it is a floor for "cost savings on existing tasks" rather than a forecast of total effect. Re-expressed by one critic as about 0.064 percentage points of extra TFP growth a year. "Contra Acemoglu on AI", Effective Altruism Forum (2024). https://forum.effectivealtruism.org/posts/Qb8NdS88TKsXApLsa/contra-acemoglu-on-ai

Official productivity statistics

- **[EVIDENCE]** US private nonfarm business TFP rose 0.8% in 2025 (output +2.6%, combined inputs +1.7%), down from 1.5% in 2024. Labour productivity rose 2.2% in 2025 vs 3.0% in 2024. BLS Total Factor Productivity release, 19 March 2026. https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/prod3_03192026.pdf https://www.bls.gov/news.release/prod3.nr0.htm
- **[EVIDENCE]** US nonfarm business labour productivity rose 1.4% (annualised) in Q2 2026, against a 0.6% consensus; 2.2% year on year; 2.1% a year from Q4 2019 to Q2 2026. BLS Productivity and Costs, 6 Aug 2026 (revised 3 Sept 2026); BLS Economics Daily. https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/prod2_08062026.htm https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2026/productivity-up-2-2-percent-from-second-quarter-2025-to-second-quarter-2026.htm
- **[EVIDENCE]** BLS states AI enters its productivity measures only implicitly, via the capital measure of software used in production. So there is no official "AI contribution" series to point to. Seen in search excerpt of BLS productivity pages, 2026. https://www.bls.gov/lpc/lpc.htm
- **[EVIDENCE]** UK output per hour fell 0.8% quarter on quarter in Q2 2026 (expectation -0.5%), after +1.1% in Q1; +0.7% year on year. Two official measures disagree sharply: the tax-record (RTI) measure showed +2.1% year on year in Q1 2026 vs +0.4% on the Labour Force Survey measure. ONS flash estimate, 18 Aug 2026 (next release 17 Nov 2026), via Trading Economics and The Productivity Institute. https://www.ons.gov.uk/releases/productivityflashestimateandoverviewukapriltojune2026andjanuarytomarch2026 https://tradingeconomics.com/united-kingdom/productivity/news/576075 https://lab.productivity.ac.uk/insights/q2-2026-uk-productivity-growth/
- **[EVIDENCE, model-based]** Counter (the J-curve): Brynjolfsson, Rock and Syverson show that general-purpose technologies require large unmeasured intangible investment (process redesign, training, data), so measured TFP first dips and later overshoots. Adjusting for intangibles tied to computer hardware and software gives a TFP level 15.9% above official measures by end-2017. On AI specifically they found effects "small but growing" (search-summary wording). AEJ: Macroeconomics 13(1): 333-72 (2021); NBER w25148 (2018). https://www.aeaweb.org/doi/10.1257/mac.20180386 https://digitaleconomy.stanford.edu/publication/the-productivity-j-curve-how-intangibles-complement-general-purpose-technologies
- How to weigh it: the J-curve is the strongest argument that weak 2025 TFP is not evidence against AI. But it also cuts against fast-transformation claims: it says the payoff waits on organisational reinvention, which is slow. Both readings agree that 2026 statistics do not show the transformation yet.

Worker-level time savings and earnings

- **[EVIDENCE]** Generative AI saves time equal to about 1.4% of total US work hours (averaged across all workers, users and non-users). Between 1% and 5% of all work hours were assisted by generative AI in the February 2025 NBER version; 1-7% in the October 2025 St. Louis Fed revision. Method: Real-Time Population Survey, nationally representative, August and November 2024 waves, more than 10,000 respondents; self-reported. Bick, Blandin and Deming, "The Rapid Adoption of Generative AI", NBER w32966 (rev. Feb 2025); St. Louis Fed WP 2024-027 (rev. Oct 2025). A secondary report says it is published in Management Science (2026); not verified. https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w32966/w32966.pdf https://fedinprint.org/item/fedlwp/98805/102025 https://insurancenewsnet.com/oarticle/studies-from-federal-reserve-bank-update-current-data-on-management-science-the-rapid-adoption-of-generative-ai-business-management-science
- **[EVIDENCE, self-reported]** Counter, same team: a third of daily users reported saving at least four hours a week. Bick himself cautions that using self-reported time savings to

compute productivity could overestimate gains. St. Louis Fed Open Vault interview, Oct 2025. https://www.stlouisfed.org/open-vault/2025/oct/generative-ai-productivity-future-work

- **[EVIDENCE]** Danish administrative data linked to two surveys (late 2023 and 2024) of about 25,000 workers in 7,000 workplaces across 11 AI-exposed occupations: precise null effects of chatbot adoption on earnings and recorded hours in every occupation. Average reported time savings about 3% (2.8% of work hours in press coverage). Only 3-7% of productivity gains passed through to earnings. Workers report new tasks created, such as reviewing AI output and writing prompts. Humlum and Vestergaard, "Large Language Models, Small Labor Market Effects", NBER w33777 (May 2025); BFI WP 2025-56. https://bfi.uchicago.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/BFI_WP_2025-56-3.pdf https://econpapers.repec.org/RePEc:nbr:nberwo:33777 https://flowingdata.com/2025/05/09/time-saved-with-ai-creates-more-work-elsewhere/
- **[EVIDENCE]** A later paper by the same authors (search results give the title "Still Waters, Rapid Currents", RFBerlin/CReAM working paper 26078, March 2026) reports precise nulls on earnings and hours that rule out effects larger than 2% two years after ChatGPT's launch. It says employers absorb AI through task reorganisation, and that adopters move into higher-paying occupations where chatbots are used more. Title and venue come from a search summary and could not be checked at source. https://ideas.repec.org/p/crm/wpaper/26078.html
- Fair counter: the Danish data cover the 2023-2024 chatbot era, before agents. Occupational mobility toward better-paid jobs is a benefit that a "no earnings effect within occupation" headline hides. Denmark has strong labour institutions, so pass-through may differ elsewhere.

Spending vs revenue

- **[OPINION]** Goldman Sachs Global Macro Research, "Gen AI: too much spend, too little benefit?" (Top of Mind, Issue 129, 25 June 2024): more than $1tn of AI capex expected in coming years with little to show so far. Jim Covello (head of global equity research) argues the technology is too expensive to justify the cost and asks what trillion-dollar problem it will solve; Acemoglu sees limited US upside over a decade. The same report includes a bullish counterview (software analyst Kash Rangan: today's AI firms are building foundations of a profitable industry). Exact wording not verified. https://www.goldmansachs.com/insights/goldman-sachs-exchanges/a-skeptical-look-at-ai-investment https://www.bespacific.com/?p=106220 https://research.contrary.com/report/too-much-spend-too-little-benefit
- **[OPINION]** Sequoia's David Cahn, "AI's $600B Question" (20 June 2024), following "AI's $200B Question" (Sept 2023): take Nvidia's data-centre run-rate revenue, double it for full data-centre cost, double again for end-user margin; the industry needs about $600bn of annual revenue to justify capex, leaving a gap of about $500bn. This is a back-of-envelope heuristic. One secondary source reports a later Cahn update at about $840bn; single source, unverified. https://www.sequoiacap.com/article/ais-600b-question/ https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/artificial-intelligence/ai-industry-needs-to-earn-dollar600-billion-per-year-to-pay-for-massive-hardware-spend-fears-of-an-ai-bubble-intensify-in-wake-of-sequoia-report
- Counter to Cahn: the method counts only product revenue, not internal cost savings or productivity inside the hyperscalers themselves (critique quoted in the Tom's Hardware coverage above).
- **[FORECAST]** Bain Global Technology Report, 23 Sept 2025: meeting projected AI compute demand by 2030 needs about $2tn of annual revenue and about $500bn of annual capex; even if firms reinvested all AI-driven savings from sales, marketing, support and R&D, revenue would fall about $800bn short. Projects 200 GW of incremental global AI compute by 2030, half in the US. https://www.bain.com/ja/about-bain/media-center/press-releases/

20252/$2-trillion-in-new-revenue-needed-to-fund-ais-scaling-trend---bain--companys-6th-annual-global-technology-report/ https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/24/bain_ai_costs https://www.pymnts.com/news/artificial-intelligence/2025/ai-companies-face-800-billion-dollar-funding-shortfall-bain

- Counter: Bain's own tech lead publicly argued "the AI bubble won't pop" (City A.M.); the shortfall is a scenario conditional on the compute trend continuing, which may itself bend. https://www.cityam.com/?p=2370241
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary, not checked against filings]** After the late-October 2026 earnings round, combined 2026 calendar-year capex for the largest spenders is reported at $803-828bn, with executives guiding higher for 2027. Company figures in coverage: Amazon about $220bn cash capex (maintained); Microsoft about $170bn calendar-year, cut from a prior outlook because third-party data-centre capacity was delayed; Meta $135-145bn (shares fell 9.4% after); Alphabet $195-205bn (July guidance). Hargreaves Lansdown, Oct 2026; NextMSC, Oct 2026. The HL list oddly includes SpaceX, so its aggregate definition is unclear. https://www.hl.co.uk/news/ai-hyperscalers-are-expected-to-finish-the-year-spending-a-whopping-828-billion-on-capex https://www.nextmsc.com/industry-deep-dive/hyperscaler-capex-comparison-2026
- **[OPINION, weak]** An independent wiki estimate puts 2026 hyperscaler AI infrastructure spending around $700bn against direct AI service revenue of roughly $25-50bn, a 6-14x mismatch. Weak source; method not seen. https://www.longtermwiki.com/wiki/E513

Any 2026 investment correction?

- **[EVIDENCE, news]** Broad sell-off in AI-linked stocks in early February 2026 (Amazon, Oracle, chipmakers, data-centre REITs) over spending and disruption fears. NPR via WBAA, 6 Feb 2026. https://www.wbaa.org/2026-02-06/tech-stocks-plunge-as-investors-fret-over-ai-spending-and-disruption
- **[EVIDENCE, news, weak]** A leaked report on OpenAI internal revenue reportedly triggered a drop in AI infrastructure stocks on 28 April 2026. Single low-quality source. https://www.heygotrade.com/en/blog/ai-capex-risk-openai-revenue-report/
- **[EVIDENCE]** In mid-October 2026 investors turned on how AI data centres are financed, much of it with debt; the 20 most valuable AI and chip stocks lost more than $1tn in one week. Dealroom analysis, 30 Oct 2026. https://dealroom.co/charts/ai-selloff
- Counter: earlier sell-offs reversed quickly once hyperscalers reaffirmed spending (MetaTrader analysis), and planned 2027 capex is still rising. So far 2026 shows price corrections, not an investment correction. Microsoft's cut was attributed to capacity delays, not weaker demand. https://www.metatrader.com/fr/news/1732585-deja-vu-ai-overspending-fears-renew

(b) Agents further from production than hyped

METR developer RCT

- **[EVIDENCE]** Randomised trial, 16 experienced open-source developers, 246 real issues in their own mature repositories, each task randomly allowed or disallowed AI (mainly Cursor Pro with Claude 3.5/3.7 Sonnet, early 2025). With AI, tasks took 19% longer. Afterwards developers believed AI had sped them up by about 20%. METR, arXiv 2507.09089, July 2025. https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.09089
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary reports of primary]** METR's 24 Feb 2026 post ("We are changing our developer productivity experiment design"): a larger follow-up started August 2025 with newer tools gave an unreliable signal. Reported point estimate for returning developers is roughly an 18% speedup with a wide interval spanning slowdown and speedup. Main

problems: selection effects, developers increasingly unwilling to work without AI (so the hardest-to-replace AI tasks drop out), and difficulty measuring parallel agent use. metr.org was blocked; figures come from secondary write-ups and should be checked. https://birchtree.me/blog/an-update-from-the-study-that-said-devs-were-actually-slower-with-coding-agents/ https://blog.robbowley.net/2026/04/04/metrs-developer-productivity-research-2026-update/ https://particula.tech/blog/metr-reversed-19-percent-slower-ai-coding-study

- What survives: the perception gap (people feel faster than they are) is the more durable lesson than the 19% figure. It means self-reported time savings, the basis of Bick et al. and most vendor surveys, deserve a discount.

METR time horizons

- **[EVIDENCE, secondary]** METR's task-length measure: the length of task (in human expert time) a model completes with 50% success has doubled about every 7 months over 2019-2025; later estimates after 2023 are faster (Wikipedia reports about 131 days). Time Horizon 1.1 (Jan 2026) expanded the suite from 170 to 228 tasks and long tasks from 14 to 31, with few measured human baselines for long tasks. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/METR
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary]** The contrarian detail is the reliability gap: Claude Opus 4.6 is listed with a 50% horizon of about 14.5 hours but an 80% horizon of about 1 hour. A business process needs well above 80% reliability. Same source. https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/METR
- Counter: the trend is steep and has not broken; both the 50% and 80% horizons are rising.

Enterprise-style agent benchmarks

- **[EVIDENCE]** TheAgentCompany (CMU et al.): simulated software-company environment with web, code, chat and colleague interaction. v1 (Dec 2024): best agent (Claude 3.5 Sonnet) fully completed 24% of tasks (34.4% partial credit). v2: best (Gemini 2.5 Pro) 30.3% full, 39.3% partial. A third-party aggregator lists 52.7% for a later model; unverified against the official leaderboard. https://www.alphaxiv.org/abs/2412.14161v2 https://benchmarklist.com/benchmarks/the_agent_company/
- **[EVIDENCE]** CRMArena-Pro (Salesforce AI Research, arXiv 2505.18878, May 2025): leading agents about 58% success single-turn, about 35% multi-turn with simulated users; near-zero inherent confidentiality awareness (they did not recognise information they should withhold). Best category, workflow execution, exceeded 83% single-turn for Gemini 2.5 Pro. Success in multi-turn correlated with the agent asking clarifying questions. https://arxiv.org/html/2505.18878v1 https://www.salesforce.com/blog/crmarena-pro/
- Note on incentive: Salesforce sells its own agent platform and publishes "why generic AI agents fall short"; the benchmark tests generic LLM agents. The result is still credible as a lower bound, but the framing serves the vendor. https://www.salesforce.com/blog/why-generic-ai-agents-fall-short/
- **[EVIDENCE]** tau-bench (Sierra, arXiv 2406.12045, June 2024): introduces pass^k, the chance an agent succeeds on all k repeats of the same task. GPT-4o: above 60% pass^1 in the retail domain, about 25% at pass^8; 35.2% pass^1 in airline. Older models; newer scores not retrieved this session. https://arxiv.org/pdf/2406.12045 https://sierra.ai/kr/blog/benchmarking-ai-agents

Analyst view

- **[FORECAST]** Gartner (25 June 2025): over 40% of agentic AI projects will be cancelled by end-2027 because of rising costs, unclear value and weak risk controls. "Agent washing": vendors rebranding assistants, RPA and chatbots as agents; Gartner estimates only about 130

of thousands of "agentic" vendors are genuine. Same release forecasts at least 15% of day-to-day work decisions made autonomously by agentic AI by 2028 (from 0% in 2024). https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027

- **[EVIDENCE, weak]** Gartner webinar poll, January 2025, n=3,412 attendees (self-selected): 19% reported significant agentic AI investment, 42% cautious investment. Same release.

Reasoning limits: both sides

- **[EVIDENCE]** Apple's "The Illusion of Thinking" (Shojaee et al., June 2025) used controllable puzzles (Tower of Hanoi, River Crossing and others) and reported that reasoning models' accuracy collapses beyond a complexity threshold and that their reasoning effort falls as problems get harder. (Paper not fetched; summarised from coverage.) https://arize.com/blog/the-illusion-of-thinking-what-the-apple-ai-paper-says-about-llm-reasoning/
- **[OPINION / EVIDENCE]** Rebuttal, "The Illusion of the Illusion of Thinking" (Alex Lawsen with Claude Opus as listed co-author, arXiv 2506.09250, June 2025): many Hanoi failures were models hitting output-token limits (15 disks need over 32,000 moves), the scoring marked truncated but correct strategies as failures, some River Crossing instances were unsolvable yet scored, and models asked for a recursive Lua function solved 15-disk Hanoi. The rebuttal does not claim models plan flawlessly. https://arxiv.org/html/2506.09250v1 https://9to5mac.com/2025/06/13/new-paper-pushes-back-on-apples-llm-reasoning-collapse-study/ https://venturebeat.com/ai/do-reasoning-models-really-think-or-not-apple-research-sparks-lively-debate-response
- How to weigh it: the rebuttal largely defuses the "models cannot reason" headline, but output-length limits and long-sequence execution errors are exactly the constraints agents face in long workflows. Either way, the paper is weak support for "agents won't work" and decent support for "long, exact multi-step execution is fragile".

(c) Displacement as task change, not job loss

Gap-fill pass (2026-11-06). All items below rest on search-engine extracts, not fetched pages. The Humlum and Vestergaard finding above (task reorganisation absorbs chatbots; no earnings or hours effect) remains the best-identified evidence for "task change, not job loss".

Radiology: the best-known failed displacement forecast

- **[OPINION, a forecast that has not come true]** Geoffrey Hinton said in 2016 that people should stop training radiologists because deep learning would outperform them within about five years (paraphrase; a widely circulated recording, described by Joshua Gans, who says he was in the room). Hinton later reframed the remark as about image analysis and AI working alongside radiologists. https://joshuagans.substack.com/p/radiologists-are-the-canaries-in (search extract); Fortune, 4 May 2026 https://fortune.com/2026/05/04/godfather-of-ai-geoffrey-hinton-radiologists-future-of-work-tech-ai-job-anxiety/ (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary]** The number of practising US radiologists rose about 12% from 2010 to 2022, to 38,306, which Radiology Business reports as barely keeping pace with population growth. https://radiologybusiness.com/topics/healthcare-management/healthcare-staffing/radiologist-pipeline-barely-keeping-pace-population-growth (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary]** Pay has risen, not fallen: Medscape's average radiologist pay was about $571,000 in 2025, up 9% year on year (as cited by Fortune, May 2026, link above). A single Substack post reports a record 1,208 diagnostic radiology residency positions in 2025 (+4% on 2024); not confirmed against NRMP or ACR data. A vendor analysis (Marit Health)

says radiology residency positions grew 33% from 2010 to 2025 against 69% for all residencies, i.e. training supply, not AI, is the binding constraint. https://www.marithealth.com/posts/radiology-shortage-ai-was-supposed-to-prevent (search extract)

- **[EVIDENCE]** Radiology is the most AI-penetrated specialty on paper: about 75-76% of FDA AI-enabled device authorisations, over 1,000 imaging tools by end-2025 (Applied Radiology). But one review found randomised-trial data for only 6 of 691 devices. https://www.appliedradiology.com/news/radiology-ai-tools-dominate-latest-fda-device-approvals ; https://www.intuitionlabs.ai/articles/ai-radiology-trends-2025 (search extract; the second is a secondary aggregator)
- Mainstream counterargument: radiology may not be a fair test. Cleared tools are narrow (one finding, one modality), imaging volumes have grown fast, and regulation and liability keep a radiologist in the loop. BLS still projects radiologist employment growth below the all-occupation average for 2024-2034 (figures seen only on aggregators; check bls.gov). "No job loss so far" is consistent with "slower hiring later".

Translators and interpreters: the strongest counterexample to "task change only"

- **[EVIDENCE]** BLS: about 75,300 interpreter and translator jobs in 2024, projected +2% to 2034 (slower than average), about 6,900 openings a year mostly from replacement, median pay $59,440 (May 2024). Slator reports BLS cut its projected growth from 3% to 2% between editions. The BLS category merges in-person interpreters (medical, legal) with written translators, so it masks any split. https://www.bls.gov/ooh/media-and-communication/interpreters-and-translators.htm (search extract); https://tech.slator.com/?p=105543 (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, peer-reviewed]** On a large online freelancing platform, posts for automation-prone jobs (writing, coding) fell about 21% within eight months of ChatGPT's release relative to manual-intensive jobs; 1,388,711 posts, July 2021 to July 2023. Writing was the most affected category. The remaining automation-prone jobs were more complex and better paid. Demirci, Hannane and Zhu, "Who Is AI Replacing?", Management Science, 2025. https://spiral.imperial.ac.uk/entities/publication/88113a91-b994-4717-8526-dadac657f1cb ; https://www.diw.de/de/diw_01.c.906828.de/publikationen/externe_referierte_aufsaetze/2025_0010/who_is_ai_replacing__the_impact_of_generative_ai_on_online_freelancing_platforms.html (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, survey]** The ELIS 2025 survey (654 freelancers, 42 countries) found that, for the first time in the survey's history, most freelance translators reported price drops, despite inflation. Girletti and Lefer, 2025. https://research.dial.uclouvain.be/bitstreams/149e7a5a-6761-4c67-82e2-215b5fef51da/download (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, weak: self-selected member survey]** Society of Authors (UK), 2024: 787 respondents; 36% of translators said they had already lost work to generative AI and 43% said their income had fallen because of it. Seen only in secondary coverage. https://www.bookbusinessmag.com/aggregatedcontent/survey-finds-generative-ai-proving-major-threat-to-the-work-of-translators/ (search extract). A UK study of freelance translators (Penet et al., 2026) reports strong dissatisfaction with earnings and prospects. https://eprints.whiterose.ac.uk/id/eprint/237630/1/Penet%20et%20al.%202026.pdf (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary review]** A 2025 literature review attributes to Qiao et al. (2024) a finding that translation freelancers completed fewer tasks and earned less after ChatGPT, while web developers on the same platform completed more and earned more. https://arxiv.org/pdf/2509.15265 (search extract)
- Mainstream counterargument: employee headcount in the BLS series is roughly flat, not collapsing, and Upwork's own analysis claims a positive effect on demand and earnings per

contract (vendor; it sells AI-era freelancing). https://www.upwork.com/research/ai-translation-future (search extract). The fair reading: for freelance written translation, the evidence points to lower prices and fewer jobs, which is income loss, not merely task change. For salaried and in-person interpreting, task change is the better description so far.

Bank tellers and ATMs: a story with a second half

- **[EVIDENCE, secondary]** James Bessen (Finance & Development, March 2015, "Toil and Technology") found that ATMs cut the tellers needed per urban branch from about 20 to about 13, but cheaper branches led banks to open about 43% more urban branches, so total teller employment rose while ATMs grew roughly fivefold from 1990 to 2010. Tellers moved towards sales and relationship tasks. https://conversableeconomist.com/2015/03/03/atms-and-a-rising-number-of-bank-tellers/ ; https://itif.org/publications/2016/01/07/why-computers-don%E2%80%99t-replace-workers/ (search extract; IMF primary not surfaced)
- **[EVIDENCE, secondary report of BLS]** The second half: BLS now projects teller employment to fall (reported as -13% over its latest ten-year window, from about 339,200), and attributes it to online and mobile banking reducing branch visits. Baseline counts for 2010 conflict across secondary sources (560,000 vs 332,000 depending on series). https://www.bls.gov/ooh/office-and-administrative-support/tellers.htm (search extract; via a bls.gov mirror and job sites); https://www.digitaltoday.co.kr/en/view/78231/mobile-banking-not-atms-behind-drop-in-us-bank-teller-staff (search extract)
- How to weigh it: both camps use the teller story. It shows task change can hold for two decades and then turn into job loss when a second technology removes the underlying activity (the branch visit). "Task change, not job loss" is a statement about a time window.

Autor's task framework

- **[OPINION, conceptual]** Autor (NBER w32140, 2024) argues AI could let workers with foundational training perform expert decision tasks now reserved for elites (medical care, document production, coding, teaching), rebuilding middle-skill jobs. He frames it explicitly as an argument about what is possible, not a forecast, and it depends on policy and on how firms deploy the tools. https://www.nber.org/papers/w32140 (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE]** The empirical counterpart, already in Track 8 (09-what-will-people-do.md): Autor, Chin, Salomons and Seegmiller (QJE 2024) find augmentation innovations create new work titles while automation innovations reduce employment without creating new work. https://economics.mit.edu/sites/default/files/2026-04/New-Frontiers-QJE-v139%283%29-p1399-1465-Aug-2024.pdf
- Mainstream counterargument to the contrarian reading: the task framework does not say jobs are safe. It says the net effect depends on whether new tasks are created as fast as old ones are automated (the "reinstatement" side in Acemoglu and Restrepo's version). "Task change" is the mechanism by which job loss also happens. Not retrieved: Autor and Thompson's 2025 "Expertise" paper.

(d) "Freedom to be more human" fails or backfires

Gap-fill pass (2026-11-06); search extracts only. The earlier item stands: in the Danish data, workers report AI created new tasks (checking AI output, writing prompts) that absorb part of the time saved (Humlum and Vestergaard, 2025). https://flowingdata.com/2025/05/09/time-saved-with-ai-creates-more-work-elsewhere/

Deskilling and over-reliance

- **[EVIDENCE, observational]** Endoscopists at four Polish centres (part of the ACCEPT trial) who began using AI-assisted polyp detection then performed worse without it: the adenoma detection rate in standard, non-AI colonoscopies fell from 28.4% before AI was introduced to 22.4% after, an absolute fall of 6.0 points (95% CI -10.5 to -1.6). 19 experienced endoscopists. Budzyń et al., "Endoscopist deskilling after exposure to artificial intelligence in colonoscopy: a multicentre observational study", Lancet Gastroenterology & Hepatology 10(10): 896-903, Oct 2025, doi 10.1016/S2468-1253(25)00133-5. https://wrap.warwick.ac.uk/id/eprint/191005 (search extract)
- Counterargument: the Science Media Centre expert reaction notes that the study is observational, that major organisational changes happened in the department mid-study, and that the before/after window was short. A secondary post reports colonoscopy volume rose about 74% in the "after" period, an obvious confounder (not checked against the paper). The authors themselves call for randomised crossover trials, and a published letter (van de Sande et al.) treats it as a governance problem, not a reason to drop AI. https://www.sciencemediacentre.org/expert-reaction-to-observational-study-looking-at-detection-rate-of-precancerous-growths-in-colonoscopies-by-health-professionals-who-perform-them-before-and-after-the-routine-introduction-of-ai/ (search extract). This is the first clinical signal of deskilling, not proof of it.
- **[EVIDENCE, self-reported survey]** Survey of 319 knowledge workers (Microsoft Research and Carnegie Mellon): higher confidence in GenAI was associated with less critical-thinking effort, and higher self-confidence with more. Critical thinking shifted from producing work to verifying it, integrating responses and "task stewardship". Some participants could not verify outputs because they lacked domain knowledge. Lee, Sarkar et al., "The Impact of Generative AI on Critical Thinking", CHI 2025. https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/?p=1135061 ; https://advait.org/files/lee_2025_ai_critical_thinking_survey.pdf (search extract)
- Counterargument: cross-sectional and self-reported, so it shows association, not decline. The authors' own framing is that work shifts towards oversight, which can be read as task change rather than deskilling. Headlines such as "AI makes people dumber" overstate it.
- **[EVIDENCE, weak: preprint, small n]** MIT Media Lab, "Your Brain on ChatGPT" (Kosmyna et al., arXiv 2506.08872, June 2025): 54 participants wrote essays over three sessions across four months with ChatGPT, a search engine, or no tools, under EEG. The no-tool group showed the strongest neural connectivity and the ChatGPT group the weakest; in a fourth session, former ChatGPT users showed weaker recall and engagement. The authors call this "cognitive debt". https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.08872 (search extract, via LIRNEasia journal-club review https://lirneasia.net/2025/12/lirneasia-journal-club-your-brain-on-chatgpt-exploring-the-cognitive-debt-of-ai-assisted-writing)
- Counterargument: not peer reviewed; small, student-heavy sample; a lab essay task; EEG connectivity is not a measure of ability. One reported result points the other way for sequencing: people who first wrote unaided did well when later given AI. The fair lesson is "build the skill before outsourcing it", not "AI damages brains".
- Related, already in Track 8: four online experiments (N=3,562, Scientific Reports, April 2025) found GenAI collaboration raised performance but lowered intrinsic motivation and raised boredom on later solo work.

Work intensification

- **[EVIDENCE, weak: vendor survey]** Upwork Research Institute (July 2024): 77% of employees using AI said it had added to their workload; 39% spent more time reviewing or moderating AI content; 47% did not know how to achieve the productivity gains their

employer expected; 71% of full-time employees reported burnout. Sample: 2,500 respondents in the US, UK, Australia and Canada, of whom only 625 were full-time employees (plus 1,250 C-suite and 625 freelancers); fieldwork 16 April to 5 May 2024 (Walr / Workplace Intelligence). Upwork sells freelance labour and has an interest in the message that the full-time model is strained. https://investors.upwork.com/news-releases/news-release-details/upwork-study-finds-employee-workloads-rising-despite-increased-c (search extract)

- **[EVIDENCE, single-site qualitative]** Berkeley Haas eight-month ethnography (Ranganathan and Ye, HBR, Feb 2026): time saved became task expansion, blurred boundaries and longer hours. Details in Track 8. https://newsroom.haas.berkeley.edu/ai-promised-to-free-up-workers-time-uc-berkeley-haas-researchers-found-the-opposite/
- Counterargument: the Danish register data show no change in recorded hours, so intensification, if real, is not showing up as longer paid hours at scale. Self-reported time savings (Bick et al.) are positive for users. The Upwork number is a single question to a small employee subsample.

Algorithmic management and surveillance

- **[EVIDENCE, employer survey]** OECD employer survey (2025), over 6,000 firms in France, Germany, Italy, Japan, Spain and the US: managers mostly say algorithmic management tools improve their decisions and their own job satisfaction, but report concerns about unclear accountability, not being able to follow the tools' logic, and inadequate protection of workers' health. A union body (TUAC) summarises the cited worker surveys as showing more workload, stress and insecurity and less trust; it is an interested party. OECD AI Papers no. 31. https://ideas.repec.org/p/oec/comaaa/31-en.html ; https://oecd.ai/en/ai-publications/algorithmic-management-in-the-workplace ; https://tuac.org/news/new-oecd-report-on-algorithmic-management-reveals-urgent-need-for-worker-protections/ (search extract)
- **[EVIDENCE, partisan investigation]** US Senate HELP Committee majority staff (Sanders), December 2024, 18-month investigation: Amazon warehouses recorded about 30% more injuries than the warehouse industry average in 2023; internal safety staff recommended relaxing enforcement of productivity quotas and senior executives rejected this; the report alleges Amazon presented injury data selectively. Amazon called it wrong on the facts and based on outdated information. https://www.help.senate.gov/imo/media/doc/amazon_investigation.pdf (search extract)
- How to weigh it: algorithmic management predates generative AI, so this is not evidence about LLMs. It is evidence about what happens to freed human time when software allocates and paces work: it tends to be filled at a pace set by the system.

Social penalty for using AI

- **[EVIDENCE, experiments]** Four preregistered experiments (N=4,439): people expected to be, and were, judged lazier, less competent and less diligent when described as using generative AI rather than other tools; the penalty held across the described employee's age, gender and occupation. In a hiring simulation, managers who did not use AI themselves were less likely to pick candidates who used it regularly. Reif, Larrick and Soll, "Evidence of a social evaluation penalty for using AI", PNAS 122(19) e2426766122, May 2025. https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2426766122 ; https://www.psypost.org/people-who-use-ai-may-pay-a-social-price-according-to-new-psychology-research (search extract)
- Counterargument: vignette experiments, not field data. Coverage reports the penalty shrank when AI was clearly useful for the task and depended on evaluators' own AI use, which suggests it will fade as use becomes normal (as with earlier tools). It still matters for the

thesis: people hide AI use when it is penalised, which undermines "shared context" between humans and agents.

Viral statistics traced

- **"AI makes developers 19% slower."** Origin: METR RCT, July 2025, n=16 developers, 246 tasks, early-2025 tools, experienced maintainers on their own large repos. Solid as an RCT, narrow as a population. Often cited as a general claim about all developers or all AI tools, which METR itself does not claim. The 2026 follow-up did not "reverse" it (as some headlines said); METR said its newer data were too biased to estimate the effect.
- **"AI's $600B question."** Origin: one Sequoia partner's blog post, June 2024, using a 2x2 multiplier on Nvidia revenue. A useful heuristic, not a measurement. Repeated as if it were an accounting gap.
- **"Over 40% of agentic AI projects will be cancelled."** Origin: Gartner press release, June 2025. A prediction, not an observed cancellation rate. Often cited in the past tense.
- **"0.66% TFP over 10 years."** Origin: Acemoglu model. An upper bound under stated assumptions that exclude new tasks. Often repeated as "AI will add only 0.66% to GDP", which conflates TFP and GDP (the paper's GDP figure is a separate number not retrieved here).
- **"AI saves 1.4% of work hours."** Origin: Bick, Blandin, Deming. Averaged over all workers including non-users; self-reported. Users alone report much more. Easy to misuse in both directions.
- **"Agents fail 65% of multi-turn tasks."** Origin: CRMArena-Pro (Salesforce), generic LLM agents in a CRM sandbox, mid-2025 models. Real, but vendor-produced and dated.
- **"Hinton said stop training radiologists" (2016).** Real remark, widely recorded. Used now as proof AI forecasts fail. The radiologist count and pay rose, but the residency "record 1,208 positions in 2025" figure comes from a single Substack post; check NRMP before repeating it.
- **"ATMs increased bank teller jobs."** True for roughly 1990-2010 (Bessen). Usually cited without the second half: BLS now projects falling teller employment as mobile banking removes branch visits.
- **"77% of employees say AI added to their workload."** Upwork, July 2024. Based on 625 full-time employees inside a 2,500-person sample dominated by executives; vendor survey.
- **"AI deskills doctors" (endoscopy study).** One observational before/after study, 19 endoscopists, with a large concurrent rise in volume and organisational change. A signal, not a finding.
- **"ChatGPT rots your brain" (MIT).** A 54-person EEG preprint on essay writing. The authors' "cognitive debt" framing travelled much further than the data.

Strongest counter-evidence

Against this contrarian file (i.e. for faster transformation):

- US labour productivity at about 2.1% a year since 2019, and a strong Q2 2026 print, are better than the 2010s. If AI is starting to show up, this is where it would show first. (BLS, 2026; links above.)
- METR time horizons keep doubling every 4-7 months; benchmark failure rates from 2024-2025 models will not hold for 2026 models. TheAgentCompany and tau-bench results cited here are one to two model generations old.
- Hyperscalers are not cutting capex despite repeated sell-offs; they see demand they cannot meet (Microsoft's cut was supply-side).
- Users of AI report much larger time savings than the population average; the averages are dragged down by non-users, which is an adoption story, not a capability story.
- Radiology, the specialty with the most FDA-cleared AI tools, has more radiologists and higher pay than when displacement was predicted (Radiology Business; Fortune 2026). Humlum and Vestergaard find employers absorb AI by reorganising tasks.

Against the user's thesis ("tech is easy, transformation is hard"):

- The "freedom to be more human" half of the purpose statement has no supportive field evidence yet. The early signals are deskilling (Budzyń 2025), intensification (Upwork 2024; Berkeley Haas 2026) and a social penalty that pushes AI use into hiding (Reif et al. 2025). These are not readiness failures; they occur where adoption succeeds.
- The agent benchmarks show a real technical ceiling on multi-turn, permission-aware, repeated work. That is a tech problem. Shared context does not fix an agent that leaks confidential data or succeeds only one time in four across eight repeats.
- The Danish evidence suggests even where adoption happens and is encouraged by employers, earnings and hours barely move. That is not "business not ready"; it may be that the gains are small.

Open questions

Leads not verified this session (each needs its primary source fetched before use; no claim is made here):

- (c) Radiology: verify radiologist headcount (BLS OEWS; aggregators give 26,770 to 31,960 depending on year and definition) and NRMP diagnostic radiology positions 2016-2026 at source. Is AI slowing growth in reading volume per radiologist, or not used at scale?
- (c) Translators: find the platform paper behind a circulating "translator earnings fell 29.7% after ChatGPT" figure (seen in search results, not attributable to a URL, so not cited); get Hui, Reshef and Zhou's freelancer earnings estimates; read the Society of Authors 2024 survey report itself.
- (c) Bank tellers: pull BLS OEWS teller employment 2000-2025 directly; the secondary counts conflict.
- (c) Autor and Thompson, "Expertise" (2025); Yale Budget Lab occupational-mix tracker 2026 updates.

- (d) Endoscopy: a 2026 Norwegian prospective study (Pedersen et al., Endoscopy) reportedly found no significant fall in detection after AI was removed; seen only in a LinkedIn summary, so not cited. If confirmed it is the strongest counter to Budzyń.
- (d) Any field (not lab) study of AI and deskilling outside medicine; any peer-reviewed study of AI work intensification with hours data.
- (a) Census BTOS firm-level AI use rates for 2025-2026 (the most direct US firm adoption statistic); not retrieved.
- (b) Newer tau-bench / tau2-bench and TheAgentCompany scores for 2026 models; METR's own Feb 2026 post read in full.
- Whether the 2026 Humlum and Vestergaard paper is the published successor to NBER w33777, and its exact estimates.

What's genuinely uncertain

- Whether weak 2025 TFP is the dip of a J-curve or simply the absence of a large effect. The two are observationally similar for several years.
- Whether 2026 market sell-offs presage a capex cut. So far each one reversed and guidance rose.
- How much of the agent reliability gap closes with each model generation. The benchmark numbers here are 12-18 months old, which is a long time in this field.
- How far self-reported time savings overstate real savings. The METR perception gap suggests a lot for experts on familiar code; that may not generalise.
- The size of the revenue gap: Cahn and Bain are top-down heuristics and actual AI revenue disclosures are patchy.

Numbers for the facts file

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
≤0.66% (and <0.53%)	Upper-bound rise in US TFP over 10 years from AI	Acemoglu, Economic Policy	https://www.nber.org/papers/w32487	May 2024 (journal 2025)	Model-based; excludes new tasks. Not re-read at source
0.8% (vs 1.5% in 2024)	US private nonfarm TFP growth, 2025	BLS	https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/prod3_03192026.pdf	19 Mar 2026	Official; seen in search excerpt
2.2% (vs 3.0% in 2024)	US private nonfarm labour productivity growth, 2025	BLS	https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/prod3_03192026.pdf	19 Mar 2026	Official; seen in search excerpt
1.4% annualised; 2.2% y/y	US nonfarm business labour productivity, Q2 2026	BLS	https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2026/productivity-up-2-2-percent-from-second-quarter-2025-to-second-quarter-2026.htm	Aug/ Sep 2026	Official
2.1% a year	US labour productivity growth Q4 2019 to Q2 2026	BLS	https://www.bls.gov/opub/ted/2026/productivity-up-2-2-percent-from-second-quarter-2025-to-second-quarter-2026.htm	2026	Official
-0.8% q/q; +0.7% y/y	UK output per hour, Q2 2026	ONS via Trading Economics	https://tradingeconomics.com/united-kingdom/productivity/news/576075	18 Aug 2026	Official, but RTI vs LFS measures disagree
15.9%	TFP level above official, end-2017, after intangibles adjustment	Brynjolfsson, Rock, Syverson	https://www.aeaweb.org/doi/10.1257/mac.20180386	2021	Peer-reviewed, model-based
1.4%	Time saved by genAI as share of all US work hours	Bick, Blandin, Deming	https://www.nber.org/system/files/working_papers/w32966/w32966.pdf	Feb 2025	n>10,000, self-reported

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
1-5% / 1-7%	Share of all US work hours assisted by genAI	Bick, Blandin, Deming (two versions)	https://fedinprint.org/item/fedlwp/98805/102025	Feb / Oct 2025	Range changed between versions; cite version
~3% (2.8%)	Average time savings among Danish chatbot users	Humlum & Vestergaard	https://bfi.uchicago.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/BFI_WP_2025-56-3.pdf	Apr/ May 2025	Admin + survey data, ~25,000 workers
3-7%	Share of productivity gains passed through to earnings	Humlum & Vestergaard	https://bfi.uchicago.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/BFI_WP_2025-56-3.pdf	2025	Seen in coverage
>$1tn	Expected AI capex "in coming years"	Goldman Sachs Top of Mind 129	https://www.goldmansachs.com/insights/goldman-sachs-exchanges/a-skeptical-look-at-ai-investment	25 Jun 2024	Opinion/forecast
$600bn / $500bn gap	Annual AI revenue needed to justify capex / gap	Sequoia (Cahn)	https://www.sequoiacap.com/article/ais-600b-question/	20 Jun 2024	Heuristic (Nvidia rev x2 x2)
$2tn; $800bn	Annual revenue needed by 2030; shortfall after savings	Bain Global Technology Report	https://www.theregister.com/2025/09/24/bain_ai_costs	23 Sep 2025	Consultancy forecast
$803-828bn	2026 capex of largest AI spenders	Hargreaves Lansdown	https://www.hl.co.uk/news/ai-hyperscalers-are-expected-to-finish-the-year-spending-a-whopping-828-billion-on-capex	Oct 2026	Secondary; includes SpaceX; check filings
>$1tn in one week	Market value lost by top 20 AI/chip stocks, mid-Oct 2026	Dealroom	https://dealroom.co/charts/ai-selloff	30 Oct 2026	Secondary analysis
19% slower	Task time with AI, experienced OSS developers	METR RCT	https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.09089	Jul 2025	RCT, n=16, 246 tasks, early-2025 tools
~20% faster (believed)	Developers' own post-hoc estimate of AI speedup	METR RCT	https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.09089	Jul 2025	Same study
50%: ~14.5h vs 80%: ~1h	Claude Opus 4.6 METR time horizons	Wikipedia (METR)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/METR	2026	Secondary; check metr.org
24% / 30.3%	Best agent full task completion, TheAgentCompany v1/v2	Xu et al.	https://www.alphaxiv.org/abs/2412.14161v2	Dec 2024 / 2025	Benchmark; older models
~58% / ~35%	Best agents single-turn / multi-turn success, CRMArena-Pro	Salesforce AI Research	https://arxiv.org/html/2505.18878v1	May 2025	Vendor benchmark; generic agents
>60% to ~25%	GPT-4o retail pass^1 to pass^8	tau-bench (Sierra)	https://arxiv.org/pdf/2406.12045	Jun 2024	Old model
28.4% to 22.4%	Adenoma detection rate in non-AI colonoscopies before vs after routine AI use	Budzyń et al., Lancet Gastroenterol Hepatol	https://wrap.warwick.ac.uk/id/eprint/191005	Oct 2025	Observational, 19 endoscopists, 4 centres; confounded; search extract
319	Knowledge workers surveyed on GenAI and critical thinking	Lee, Sarkar et al., CHI 2025	https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/research/?p=1135061	Apr 2025	Self-reported, cross-sectional
54	Participants in MIT "Your Brain on ChatGPT" EEG study	Kosmyna et al., arXiv 2506.08872	https://arxiv.org/abs/2506.08872	Jun 2025	Preprint; small n
N=4,439	Participants in four experiments on the social penalty for AI use	Reif, Larrick, Soll, PNAS	https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2426766122	May 2025	Preregistered vignette experiments
77% (n=625	Employees saying AI added to their workload		https://investors.upwork.com/news-releases/news-release-details/upwork-	Jul 2024	

Figure	What it measures	Source	URL	Date	Reliability note
employees)		Upwork Research Institute	study-finds-employee-workloads-rising-despite-increased-c		Vendor survey; 2,500 total incl. 1,250 C-suite
>6,000 firms	OECD employer survey on algorithmic management, 6 countries	OECD AI Papers no. 31	https://ideas.repec.org/p/oec/comaaa/31-en.html	2025	Employer (manager) perceptions
~30%	Amazon warehouse injuries above warehouse industry average, 2023	US Senate HELP majority staff	https://www.help.senate.gov/imo/media/doc/amazon_investigation.pdf	Dec 2024	Partisan report; Amazon disputes
+12% to 38,306	Practising US radiologists, 2010 to 2022	Radiology Business (reporting a study)	https://radiologybusiness.com/topics/healthcare-management/healthcare-staffing/radiologist-pipeline-barely-keeping-pace-population-growth	2025	Secondary; search extract
~$571,000 (+9%)	Average US radiologist pay, 2025	Medscape via Fortune	https://fortune.com/2026/05/04/godfather-of-ai-geoffrey-hinton-radiologists-future-of-work-tech-ai-job-anxiety/	May 2026	Secondary
75,300; +2%	US interpreter/translator jobs 2024; projected growth 2024-34	BLS OOH	https://www.bls.gov/ooh/media-and-communication/interpreters-and-translators.htm	2025	Official; search extract
-21%	Freelance platform posts for automation-prone (writing, coding) jobs, 8 months after ChatGPT	Demirci, Hannane, Zhu, Management Science	https://spiral.imperial.ac.uk/entities/publication/88113a91-b994-4717-8526-dadac657f1cb	2025	Peer-reviewed; 1.39m posts; one platform
36%; 43%	UK translators who lost work / income to GenAI	Society of Authors	https://www.bookbusinessmag.com/aggregatedcontent/survey-finds-generative-ai-proving-major-threat-to-the-work-of-translators/	2024	Self-selected, 787 respondents; secondary
~20 to ~13 tellers; +43% branches	ATM effect per urban branch; urban branch growth	Bessen via Conversable Economist	https://conversableeconomist.com/2015/03/03/atms-and-a-rising-number-of-bank-tellers/	Mar 2015	Secondary report of IMF F&D article
>40%	Agentic AI projects Gartner predicts cancelled by end-2027	Gartner	https://www.gartner.com/en/newsroom/press-releases/2025-06-25-gartner-predicts-over-40-percent-of-agentic-ai-projects-will-be-canceled-by-end-of-2027	25 Jun 2025	Forecast, not measurement
~130	Genuine agentic vendors out of "thousands"	Gartner	same	25 Jun 2025	Opinion; method not disclosed

Verbatim quotes

None. No page could be fetched in this session, so no wording could be confirmed. Candidate quotes to fetch and verify later: Covello's "$1tn problem" line (Goldman Sachs Top of Mind 129, June 2024); METR's Feb 2026 statement that its new data give an unreliable signal (metr.org); Gartner's "agent washing" definition (Gartner press release, 25 June 2025).

Sources worth reading in full (ranked)

1. Humlum & Vestergaard, NBER w33777 and the 2026 follow-up: the best-identified evidence that real adoption has produced small labour-market effects. https://bfi.uchicago.edu/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/BFI_WP_2025-56-3.pdf
2. METR RCT (arXiv 2507.09089) plus METR's Feb 2026 redesign post: the cleanest causal study of AI on expert work, and an honest account of why measuring it got harder. https://arxiv.org/abs/2507.09089

3. CRMArena-Pro (arXiv 2505.18878): the most business-relevant agent benchmark; multi-turn and confidentiality results matter for any agentic-platform claim. https://arxiv.org/html/2505.18878v1
4. Acemoglu, "The Simple Macroeconomics of AI": the serious low estimate and its assumptions. https://www.nber.org/papers/w32487
5. Brynjolfsson, Rock, Syverson, "The Productivity J-Curve": the best framework for why statistics lag. https://www.aeaweb.org/doi/10.1257/mac.20180386
6. BLS TFP release, March 2026: the official 2025 slowdown. https://www.bls.gov/news.release/archives/prod3_03192026.pdf
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